The Book of Humanity

Significant Literary Features

Gen 5:1 - “Adam” or “Mankind”

This is the book of the toledot of “adam.”
In the day God created “adam,” in the likeness of God he made him.
Male and female he created them.
And he blessed them.
And he called their name “adam” in the day he created them.

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Gen 5:1 - “Adam” or “Mankind”

- “adam” as “mankind”
  - first occurs in creation (make mankind in our image)
  - 5:1 refers to that creation

Genesis 1

“Let us make “adam” as our image, according to our likeness . . .
And God created the “adam” as his image,
As the image of God he created him, male and female he created them . . .
And he blessed them.

Genesis 5

In the day God created “adam,” in the likeness of God he made him.
Male and female he created them.
And he blessed them, and he called their name “adam” in the day he created them.

best understood as “mankind”

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Gen 5:1 - "Adam" or "Mankind"

This is the book of the toledot of "adam."
In the day God created "adam," in the likeness of God he made him.
*Male and female he created **them**.*
*And he blessed **them**.*
*And he called their **name** "adam" in the day he created them.*

Not the "family line of Adam" but what developed from mankind.

Genesis 5—11

Chapter 5

PN_1 lived x years and begat PN_2.
PN_1 lived after he begat PN_2 y years
and begat sons and daughters.
All the days of PN_1 were z years;
and he died.

Chapter 11

PN_1 lived x years and begat PN_2.
PN_1 lived after he begat PN_2 y years
and begat sons and daughters.
~~All the days of PN_1 were z years;~~
~~and he died.~~

God remembered Noah

de-creation
crescendo

chiasm

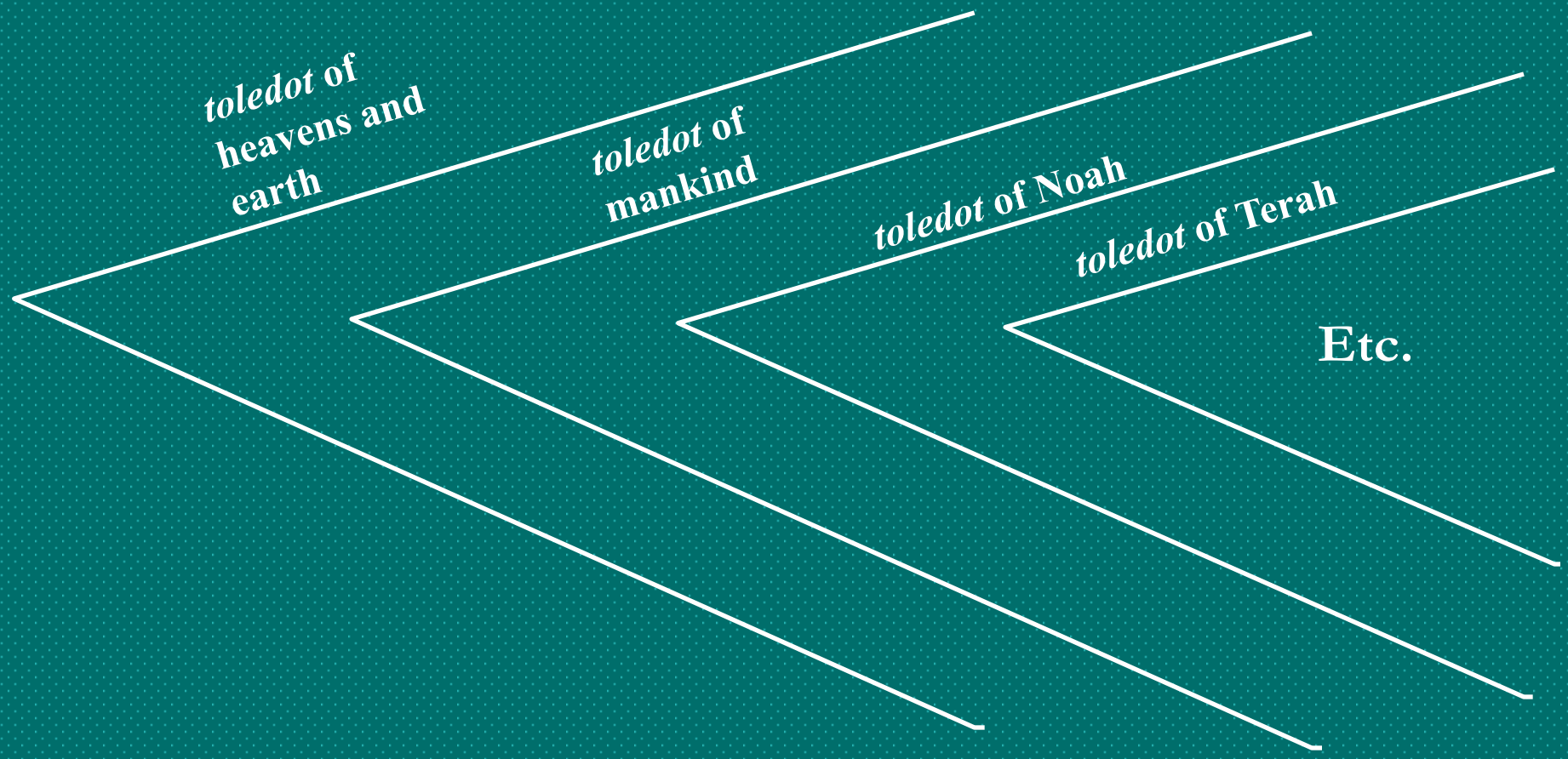
re-creation
decrescendo

ten generations

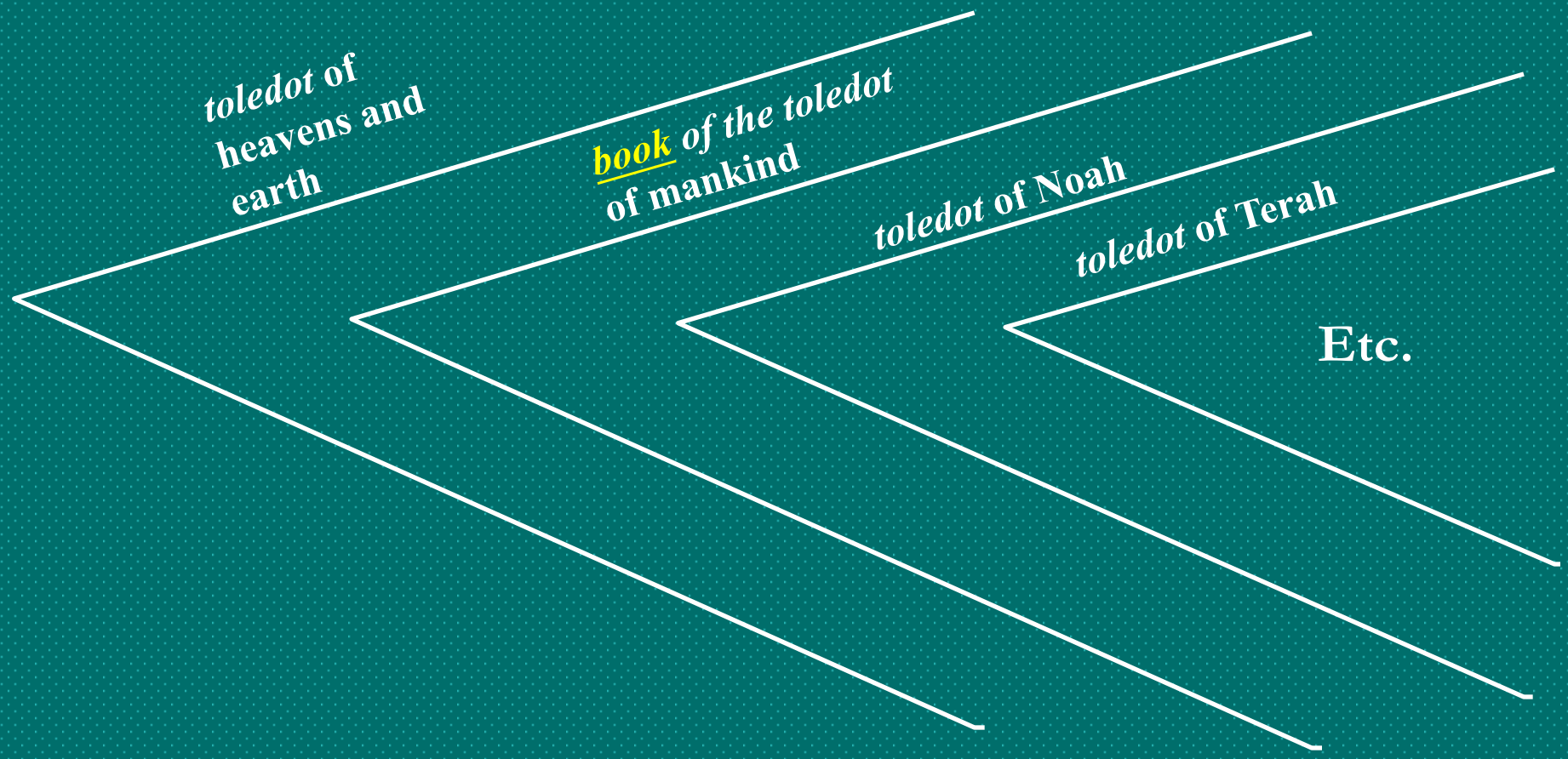
flood narrative

ten generations

Toledot Structure



Toledot Structure



Book of the Toledot

- Significant Change in form
  - change in repetition is always a focal point
- "book of the toledot" occurs in one other place.

- "The book of the toledot of mankind" (Gen 5:1)
- "The book of the toledot of Jesus Christ" (Matt 1:1)

- This is what came from mankind (sin & death)
- This is what came from Jesus Christ (salvation & life)

Book of the Toledot of Mankind

- Creation:
  - Humankind created to represent God in producing life
- Eden-Cain Stories
  - What happened to creation in the hands of humanity
  - Humankind ruins God's work
- Book of the Toledot of Mankind
  - What happens to humanity
  - Death
- But what happened with mankind *(adam)* began with Adam *(adam)*

In the day God created mankind [adam], in the likeness of God he made him.
Male and female he created them.
And he blessed them,
and he called their name "adam" in the day he created them.

"mankind" based on context and allusion to creation

And Adam [adam] was 130 years old

And he begat in his likeness, according to his image

And he called his name Seth

"Adam" based on context and clear reference to a person

And Adam was 130 years old

And he begat in his likeness, according to his image

And he called his name Seth

- Usually understood that . . .
  - Adam has a son in the divine image
  - Humanity in the image of God continues in spite of sin

And Adam was 130 years old

And he begat in his likeness, according to his image

And he called his name Seth

- Consider . . .
  - Closest direct referent of “his” is Adam
  - This verse begins a new form (now a genealogy)
  - This verse begins with ויהי
    - "and it was”
    - a major structural indicator of something new
- Thus, it is Adam bearing a son in ***his own*** image.
- Death

Narrative Insertions

- The genealogy of death (Genesis 5) contains two narrative insertions:
  - Enoch
  - Lamech

- Note:
  - Narrative insertions are anomalies, therefore important
  - They provide exegetical clues

Enoch Insertion

- Instead of the formulaic “he lived” is “he walked with God.”
- Instead of the formulaic “he died” is “God took him.”
- In the middle of a death genealogy, some one lives *(hope)*
- ***But***, both Cain’s and Adam’s line have an Enoch.
  - A clue for the reader to compare the two
  - “Enoch” means celebration, but celebration of what?
    - Cain’s Enoch:
      - human independence of God, temporary security on earth
    - Adam’s Enoch:
      - life with God.

Lamech Insertion

- Lamech's insertion contains speech *(2nd importance indicator)*
- Hope for relief from hard labor for food
- Hope in future generations
- ***But***, both Cain's and Adam's line have a Lamech.
  - A clue for the reader to compare the two
    - Cain's Lamech: justifies self, claiming God's protection regardless of his particular sin.
    - Adam's Lamech: hopes for deliverance from the consequences of sin in general.

Adam's Genealogy

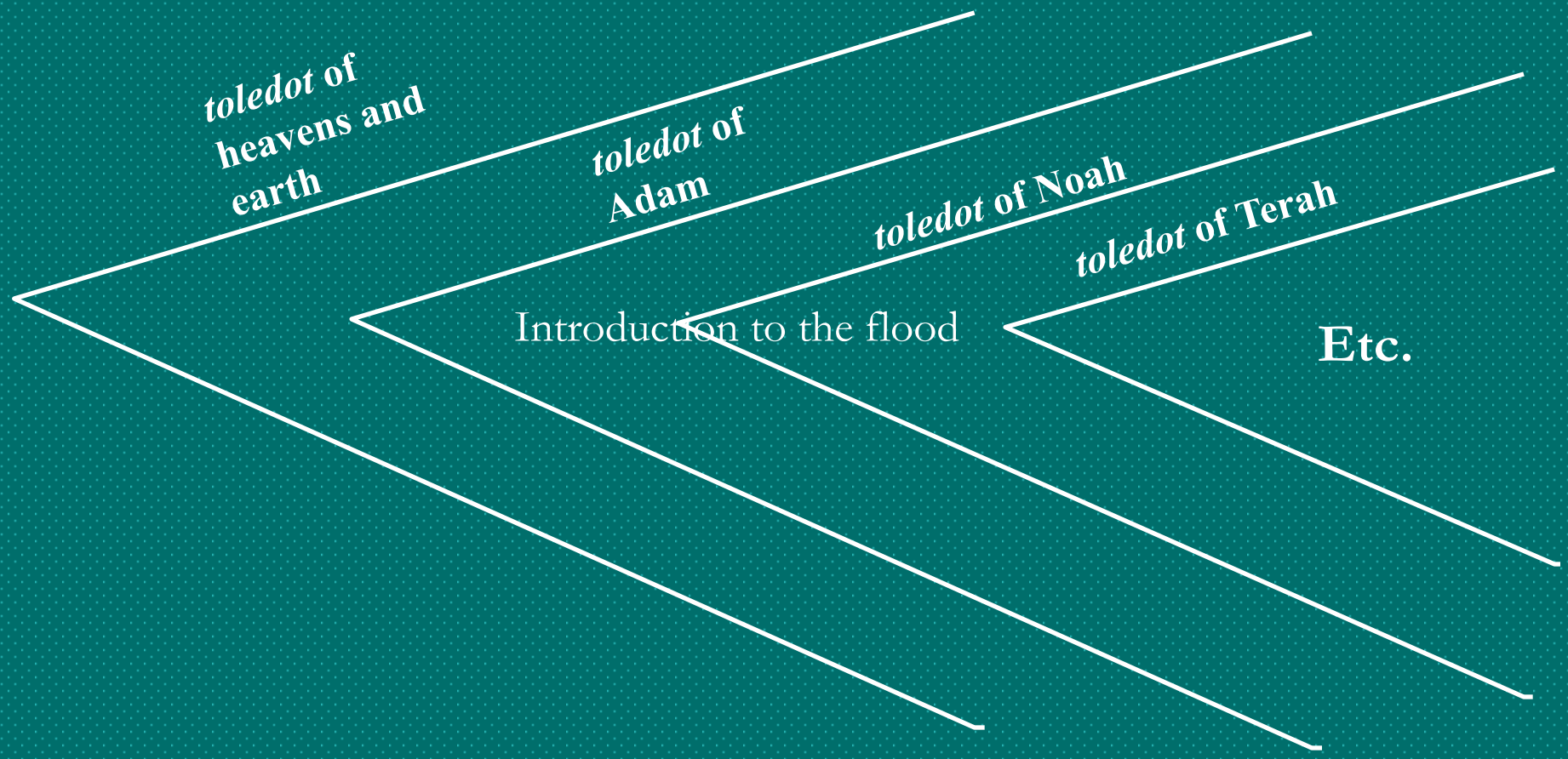
- Demonstrates that all of Adam's descendants fell under the curse of death.
- Narrative Insertions
  - Hope for life found in the Lord
  - A desire for deliverance

Genesis 5—11

A Structural Problem

- A *toledot*, which . . .
  - represents a major structural break,
  - always switches from narrative to genealogy or genealogy to narrative
  - always begins a new section,
  - always begins a new topic . . .
- here occurs in the middle of what appears to be a continuous narrative.

Genesis 5—11


toledot of heavens and earth
toledot of Adam
toledot of Noah
toledot of Terah
Introduction to the flood
Etc.

Genesis 5—11

Introduction to the flood . . .	This is the *toledot* of Noah	Introduction to the flood . . .
Gen 6:1-8	(Gen 6:9a)	Gen 6:9b-22

Narrative continuum

This is the toledot of Noah.

And the Lord saw that the evil of mankind had become great on the earth and all the formation of the thoughts of his heart was evil continually. And the Lord regretted that he had made mankind on the earth, and his heart was grieved. And the Lord said, "I will wipe mankind, whom I have created, from the face of the earth—from mankind to animals, to creeping things, and birds of the heavens—for I regret that I have made them." But Noah found favor in the sight of the Lord. Noah was a righteous man. He was blameless among his contemporaries: Noah walked with God. Now Noah begat three sons: Shem, Ham, and Japheth. And the earth was corrupt in the sight of God, and the earth was filled with violence. And God observed the earth and, indeed, it was corrupted, for all living creatures on the earth were corrupt. So God said to Noah, . . . (Gen 6:5–13) This translation retains some of the Hebrew word order for the purpose of retaining the emphasis of the original text.

Structural Problem

- Introduction of a new topic?
  - Gen 5:1—6:1-8 presents . . .
    - the spread of Adam's sin . . .
    - the consequences of that sin upon humanity . . .
    - resulting in God's decision to destroy all flesh.
  - However, in the process, the theme of deliverance is ***subtly*** introduced (Enoch, Lamech).
  - Gen 6:1-8: evil on the earth, intent to destroy
  - **Gen 6:9a: "This is the *toledot* of Noah"**
  - Gen 6:9b-22: evil on the earth, intent to destroy

Plus Deliverance *(the new topic)*

Structural Problem

- The toledot of Noah represents the first time the idea of deliverance appears in Genesis 1—11. . .
- A MAJOR CHANGE!!
- Into the cycle of sin and judgment . . .
- Salvation is introduced!!

Toledot of Noah

Problem

Read ***structurally***,
it makes sense (introducing a new topic),

but ***not*** when read ***narrativally***,
since it occurs in
the middle of a continuous narrative.

Toledot of Noah

Question!

Was Noah saved because he was righteous?

Toledot of Noah

Question!

Was Noah saved because he was righteous?

- If read structurally . . . NO

And the Lord saw that the evil of mankind had become great on the earth and all the formation of the thoughts of his heart was evil continually. And the Lord regretted that he had made mankind on the earth, and his heart was grieved. And the Lord said, "I will wipe mankind, whom I have created, from the face of the earth—from mankind to animals, to creeping things, and birds of the heavens—for I regret that I have made them." But Noah found favor in the sight of the Lord.

Toledot of Noah: Salvation thru Judgment

Noah was a righteous man. He was blameless among his contemporaries: Noah walked with God. Now Noah begat three sons: Shem, Ham, and Japheth. And the earth was corrupt in the sight of God, and the earth was filled with violence. And God observed the earth and, indeed, it was corrupted, for all living creatures on the earth were corrupt. So God said to Noah, . . .

Toledot of Noah

Question!

Was Noah saved because he was righteous?

- If read structurally . . . NO
- If read narrativally . . . YES

And the Lord saw that the evil of mankind had become great on the earth and all the formation of the thoughts of his heart was evil continually. And the Lord regretted that he had made mankind on the earth, and his heart was grieved. And the Lord said, "I will wipe mankind, whom I have created, from the face of the earth—from mankind to animals, to creeping things, and birds of the heavens—for I regret that I have made them." But Noah found favor in the sight of the Lord. Noah was a righteous man. He was blameless among his contemporaries: Noah walked with God. Now Noah begat three sons: Shem, Ham, and Japheth. And the earth was corrupt in the sight of God, and the earth was filled with violence. And God observed the earth and, indeed, it was corrupted, for all living creatures on the earth were corrupt. So God said to Noah, . . .

Toledot of Noah

Question!

Was Noah saved because he was righteous?

- If read structurally . . . NO
- If read narrativally . . . YES
- SO, which is it??

Toledot of Noah

Consider!

Why did God change his mind about judging the earth?

- The reason for the flood:

  the evil nature of humanity's heart

- The reason for the promise of no future flood:

  the evil nature of humanity's heart

Why the same reason for both??

Genesis 5—11

God's Change in Stance

- Consider the theme of "heart"
  - Gen 6:5 – "the thoughts of ***man's*** heart"
  - Gen 6:6 – "it grieved [***the Lord***] in his heart"
  - Gen 8:21 – "***the Lord*** said in his heart"
  - Gen 8:21 – "the heart of ***man*** is evil from his youth"
- This usage of "heart" for man and God ***connects the two*** and ***connects the two separate mentions***.

And the Lord saw that the evil of mankind had become great on the earth and all the formation of the thoughts of his heart was evil continually. And the Lord regretted that he had made mankind on the earth, and his heart was grieved. And the Lord said, "I will wipe mankind, whom I have created, from the face of the earth . . ."

And the Lord said in his heart "I will not again curse the ground on the account of mankind, for the thought of mankind's heart is evil from his you . . . "

*And the Lord saw that the evil of mankind had become great on the earth and all the formation of the thoughts of his **heart** was evil continually. And the Lord regretted that he had made mankind on the earth, and his heart was grieved. And the Lord said, "I will wipe mankind, whom I have created, from the face of the earth . . ."*

*And the Lord said in his heart"I will not again curse the ground on the account of mankind, for the thought of mankind's **heart** is evil from his you . . . "*

*And the Lord saw that the evil of mankind had become great on the earth and all the formation of the thoughts of his **heart** was evil continually. And the Lord regretted that he had made mankind on the earth, and his **heart** was grieved. And the Lord said, "I will wipe mankind, whom I have created, from the face of the earth . . ."*

*And the Lord said in his **heart** "I will not again curse the ground on the account of mankind, for the thought of mankind's **heart** is evil from his you . . . "*

Genesis 5—11

God's Change in Stance

- Both reasons are associated with God's heart:
  - The association with reference to judgment is explained
    - God was grieved in his heart
  - The association with reference to deliverance is ***not*** explained
    - God said in his heart (i.e., "said to himself")
    - but, the impetus for that statement is not given.
- How can God act in deliverance this time?
- The answer is left in the obscurity of the heart of the transcendent creator.

Genesis 5-11
Structure & Literary Features

Summary

- Overall Topic: What happens with fallen humanity
  - Humanity condemned to die
  - Foreshadowing hope for deliverance
  - Hope for deliverance provided
    - based on righteousness
    - based on nothing but God's heart